

Automation Starter Kit

The 10 Business Automations Every Entrepreneur
Needs - Plus the Tools and Workflows to Build Them

*Your time is your most valuable asset. Automation does not replace you -
it frees you to do the work only you can do.*

The Automation Mindset

Most entrepreneurs automate too late, too little, or the wrong things. The goal is not to automate everything - it is to automate the repetitive, low-judgment tasks that eat your hours without growing your business. If you do something more than 3 times, it should be automated.

The 3-Question Automation Filter

- Is this task repetitive? Does it happen on a schedule or triggered by an event?
- Does it require human judgment, creativity, or relationship? If yes, keep it human.
- What would happen if it was done 10x faster with zero manual effort?

Start with automations that save at least 2 hours per week. Those 2 hours compound into 100+ hours per year.

Your Tool Stack

The Core Automation Stack (Budget-Friendly)

Zapier or Make (formerly Integromat): Connect apps and automate workflows without code. Start free.

Notion or Airtable: Database and project management. The hub for your systems.

Calendly: Automate scheduling - no more back-and-forth emails.

ConvertKit or Mailchimp: Email automation and sequences.

Stripe: Payment collection, invoicing, and subscription management.

Typeform or Tally: Smart forms and surveys that feed into your automation.

Slack or Telegram: Receive automated alerts and updates.

Google Sheets: Free, powerful database for lightweight automation data.

Do not buy tools you do not have a workflow for. Start with one automation, master it, then expand.

10 Essential Business Automations

Automation 1 - New Lead Notification

When: Someone fills out your contact or lead form.

Automate: Send yourself a Slack/Telegram message with their details. Log to Google Sheets. Add to email list.

Tools: Typeform + Zapier + Slack + Google Sheets

Automation 2 - Welcome Email on Signup

When: Someone subscribes to your email list.

Automate: Trigger a welcome email sequence immediately. Tag them by source for segmentation.

Tools: ConvertKit or Mailchimp (built-in automation)

Automation 3 - Payment Confirmation & Delivery

When: Customer completes a purchase.

Automate: Send confirmation email with receipt and product access. Notify you via Slack. Log order to sheet.

Tools: Stripe + Zapier + Gmail or ConvertKit

Automation 4 - Appointment Scheduling & Reminders

When: Client books a call or meeting.

Automate: Confirm booking instantly. Send reminder 24 hours and 1 hour before. Add to your calendar.

Tools: Calendly (fully built-in, zero setup needed)

Automation 5 - Client Onboarding Sequence

When: New client signs or pays.

Automate: Send onboarding email with instructions, forms, and next steps. Create their project folder. Schedule kickoff.

Tools: Stripe + Zapier + Google Drive + ConvertKit

Automation 6 - Invoice & Payment Follow-Up

When: Invoice is created or goes unpaid after X days.

Automate: Send invoice automatically on a schedule. Follow up with a reminder email if unpaid after 3 and

7 days.

Tools: Stripe or QuickBooks + Zapier

Automation 7 - Social Media Scheduling

When: You create content in batches.

Automate: Schedule all posts for the week in one sitting. Auto-publish at optimal times.

Tools: Buffer, Later, or Metricool

Automation 8 - Review / Testimonial Request

When: Project is completed or X days after purchase.

Automate: Send an email asking for a Google review or testimonial with a direct link.

Tools: Zapier + Gmail / ConvertKit - trigger on Stripe payment + delay 7 days

Automation 9 - Re-engagement for Cold Leads

When: A lead has not opened your emails in 60+ days.

Automate: Trigger a re-engagement sequence (3 emails). If still no action, unsubscribe automatically to protect deliverability.

Tools: ConvertKit or Mailchimp (built-in segment automation)

Automation 10 - Weekly Business Report

When: Every Monday morning.

Automate: Pull data from Stripe (revenue), Google Analytics (traffic), and email platform (open rates). Compile into a summary sent to your email or Slack.

Tools: Zapier + Stripe + Google Analytics + Slack

Step-by-Step: Building Your First Zapier Workflow

This walkthrough builds Automation 1 - the new lead notification - from scratch.

1. Create a free account at zapier.com.
2. Click 'Create Zap'.
3. Trigger App: Choose your form tool (Typeform, Tally, Google Forms).
4. Trigger Event: Choose 'New Entry' or 'New Response'.
5. Connect your form account and select your specific form.
6. Action App: Choose Slack (or Gmail for email notification).
7. Action Event: Choose 'Send Channel Message' (Slack) or 'Send Email' (Gmail).
8. Map the fields: Include name, email, and message from the form.
9. Test the Zap with a sample submission.
10. Turn the Zap on. Done.

Your first Zap will take 20 minutes. Your tenth will take 5. The skill compounds quickly.

Automation ROI Calculator

Before building an automation, calculate whether it is worth your time to build.

The Formula

Hours saved per week x Your hourly rate x 52 weeks = Annual value of automation

If the automation takes 4 hours to build and saves 3 hours per week at \$50/hour:

3 hours x \$50 x 52 = \$7,800 in annual value from 4 hours of setup. That is a 1,950% return.

Priority Matrix

High time savings + Easy to build: Do these FIRST.

High time savings + Hard to build: Plan and hire help if needed.

Low time savings + Easy to build: Do these when you have spare time.

Low time savings + Hard to build: Skip these entirely.

Automate the work that repeats. Protect the work that requires you. That is the formula for a scalable business.